

BECOMING AN IR ROCK STAR

(Superstars 2.0)

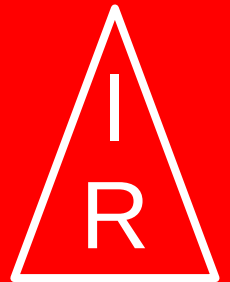


Matt Scheurer

October 16, 2026



```
if (badEvent == "true") {  
    perform = "Incident Response";  
}
```



About Me

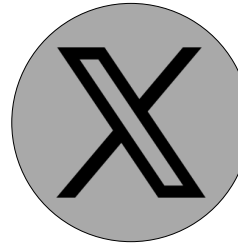
I work for a big well-known organization...



As Vice President (VP) of Computer Security and Incident Response (IR). However, I have many years of hands-on technical experience, including Digital Forensics & Incident Response (DFIR).



<https://www.linkedin.com/in/mattscheurer>



<https://x.com/c3rkah>

Where I volunteer...

I am an Official



Advocate

<https://www.hackingisnotacrime.org>



Advisory Board: Information
Technology and Cybersecurity

<https://www.mywccc.org>



Women's Security Alliance
(WomSA) Technical Mentor

<https://www.womsa.org>

Disclaimer!

Yes, I have a day job.
However...

Opinions expressed are based solely on my own independent security research and do not express or reflect the views or opinions of my employer.



Agenda

1) Incident Response (IR) Essentials

2) Q&A

Slide Deck



<https://slides.dfir-matt.com>

Why this talk?

Principal Security Engineer Job
(Tier 4)

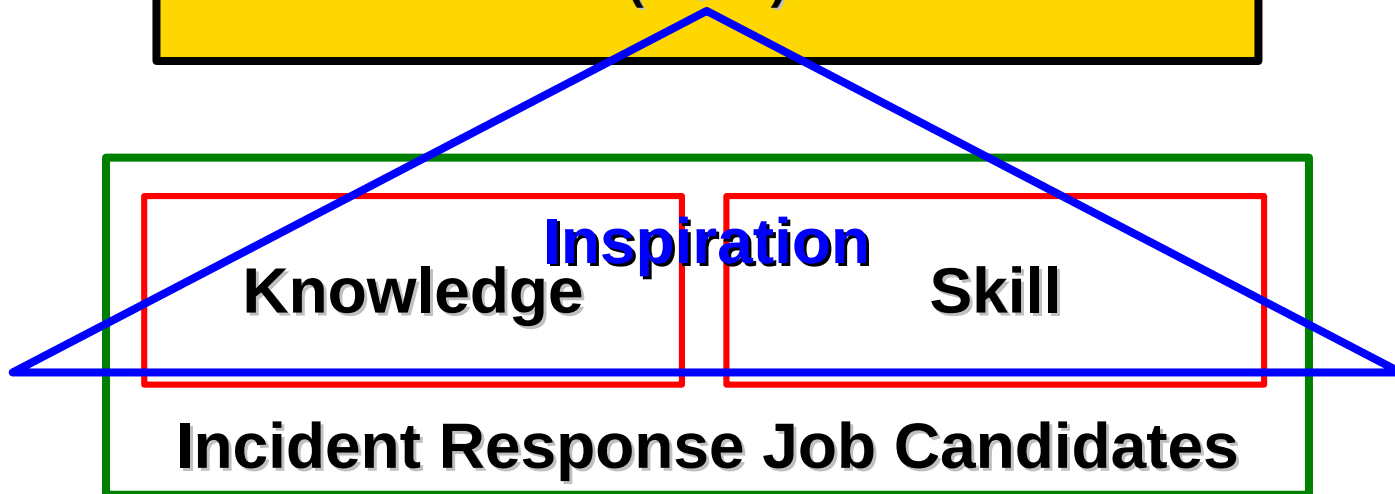
Knowledge

Skill

Incident Response Job Candidates

Why this talk?

Principal Security Engineer Job
(Tier 4)



Role of Incident Response



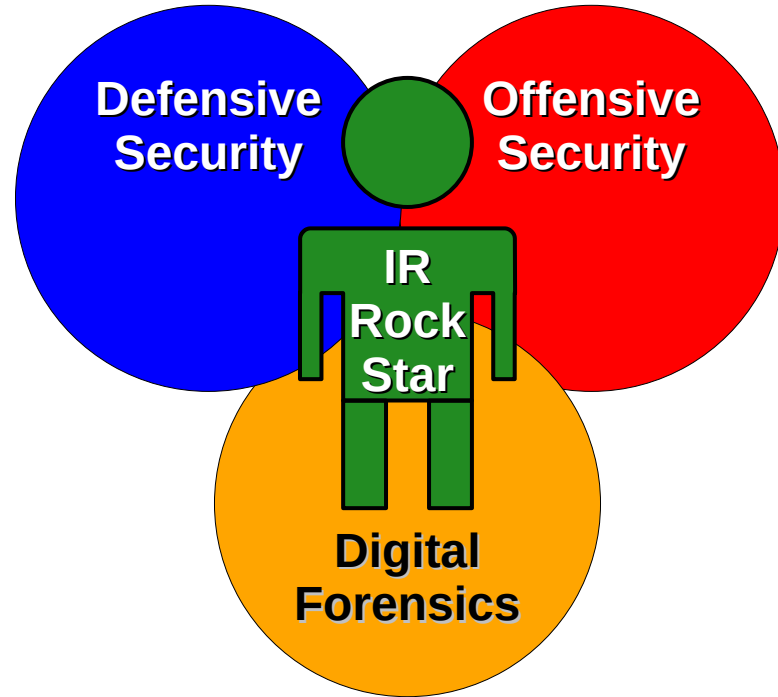
Security Investigation

- Who
- What
- When
- Where
- Why
- How

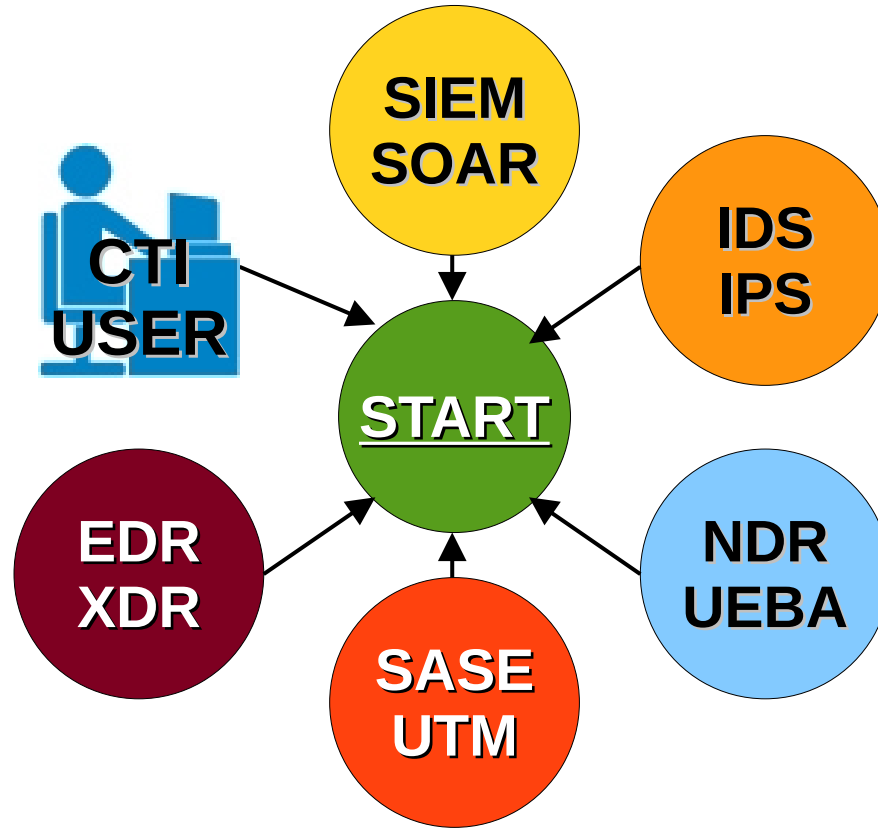
Aspiring Incident Responders



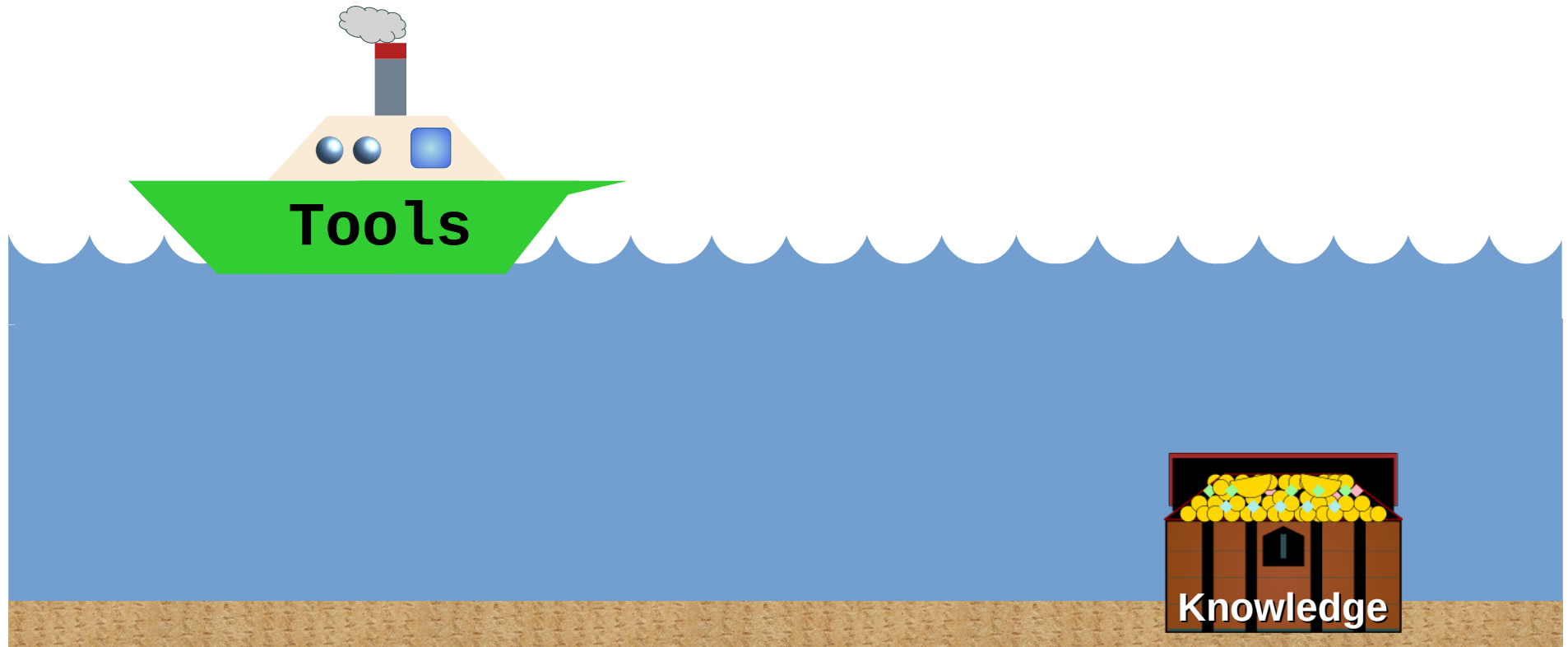
Incident Responders



When IR starts



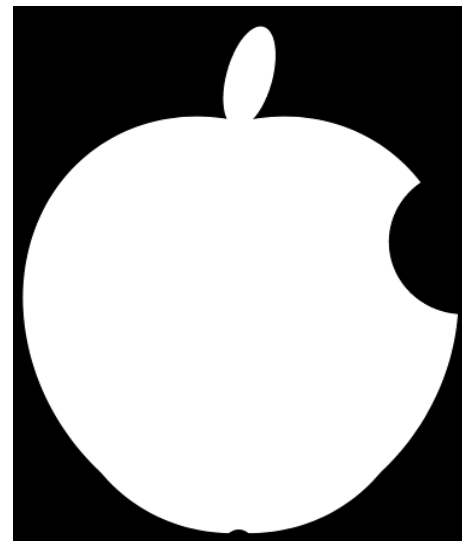
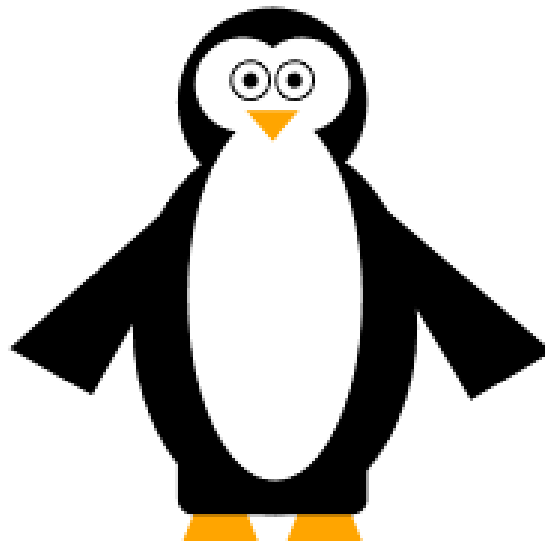
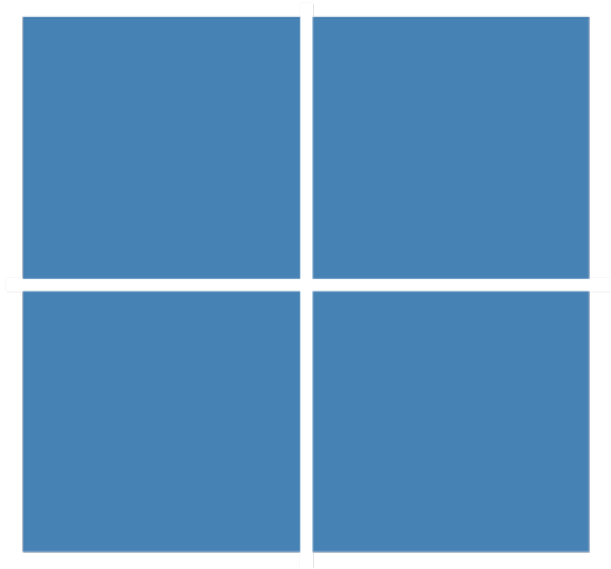
Diving Deep



Alert Dispositions

	True (Detection)	False (Detection)
Positive (Condition)	True Positive: Correctly classifying malicious activity as malicious	False Positive: Incorrectly classifying benign activity as malicious
Negative (Condition)	True Negative: Correctly classifying benign activity as benign	False Negative: Incorrectly classifying malicious activity as benign

Operating Systems

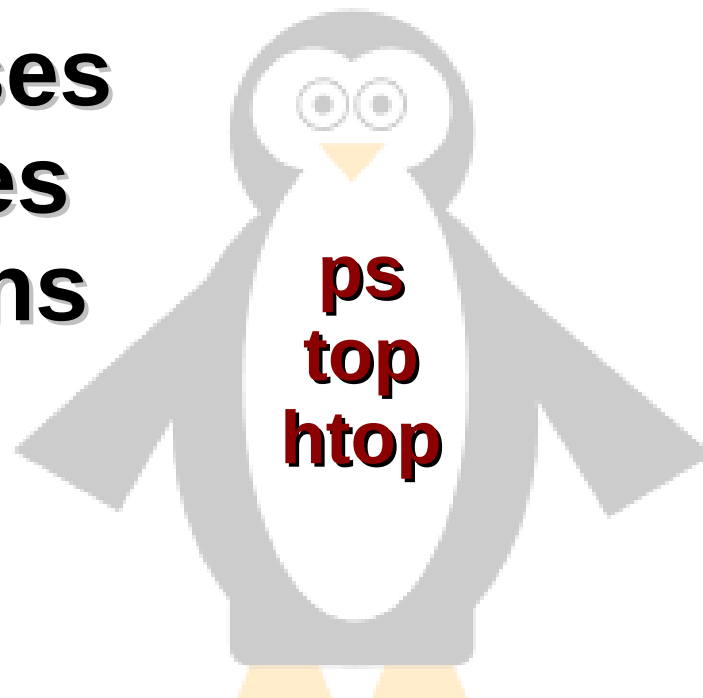


OS Processes & More

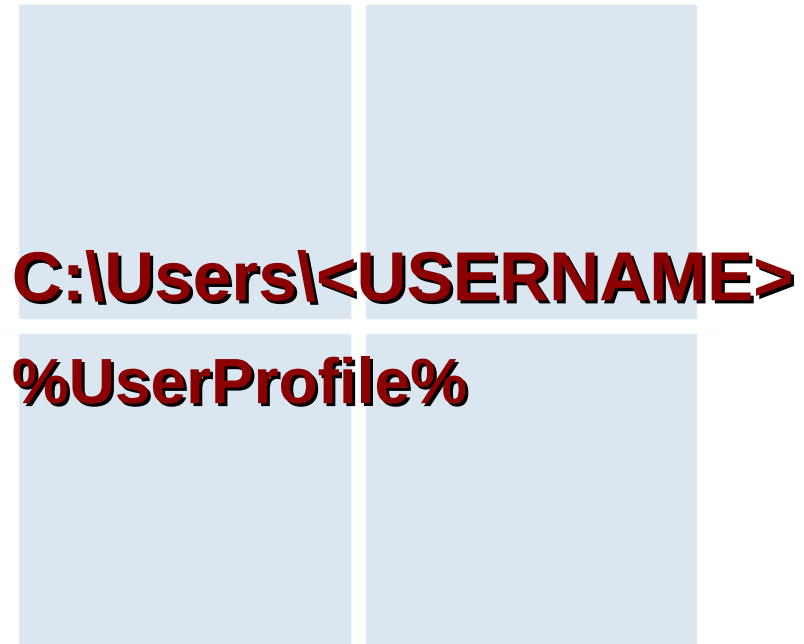
Task Manager
(taskmgr.exe)

Services
(services.msc)

Processes
Services
Daemons



Default User directory



A diagram showing the Windows user directory structure. It consists of two light blue squares stacked vertically. The top square contains the text **C:\Users\<USERNAME>** and the bottom square contains the text **%UserProfile%**.

C:\Users\<USERNAME>
%UserProfile%



A diagram showing the Linux user directory structure. It features a cartoon penguin character in the background. Overlaid on the penguin is the text **/home/<USERNAME>**.

/home/<USERNAME>

Windows Filesystem

Configuration

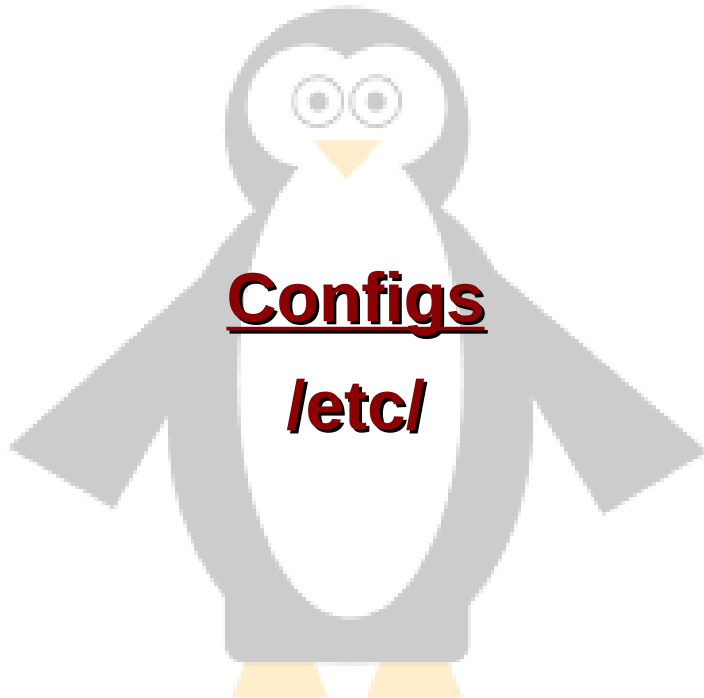
Registry (regedit.exe)

Hive files

C:\Windows\System32\

- \config
 - \config\RegBack
- %UserProfile%
- \NTUSER.DAT

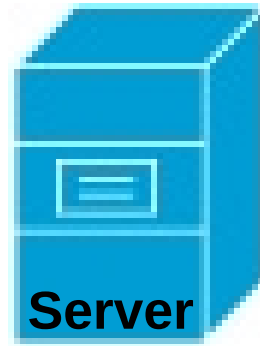
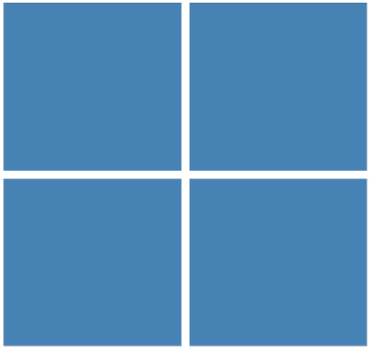
Linux Filesystem



- Linux Foundation
 - Filesystem Hierarchy Standard (FHS)



Various Log files



Apps

Windows Logs

Application
Security
Setup
System
etc.

C:\Windows\System32\winevt\Logs

- %System32%
- *.evtx

Event Viewer	(eventvwr.exe)
Event ID	Logon type



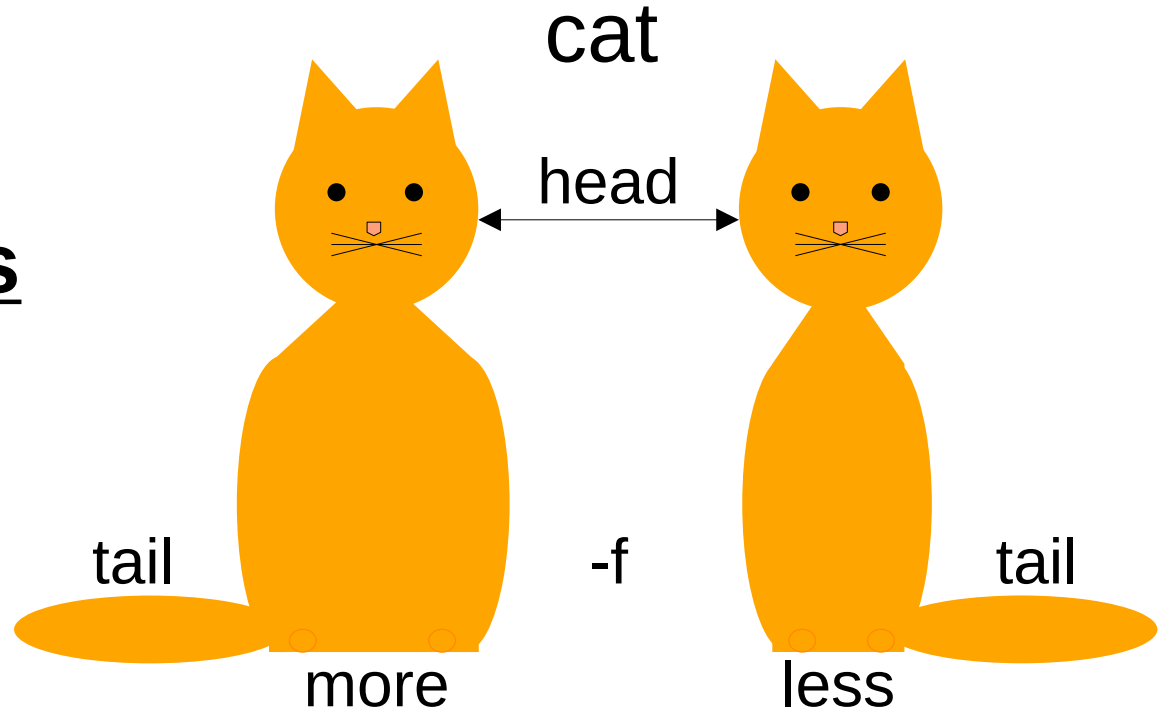
Linux Logs

Path

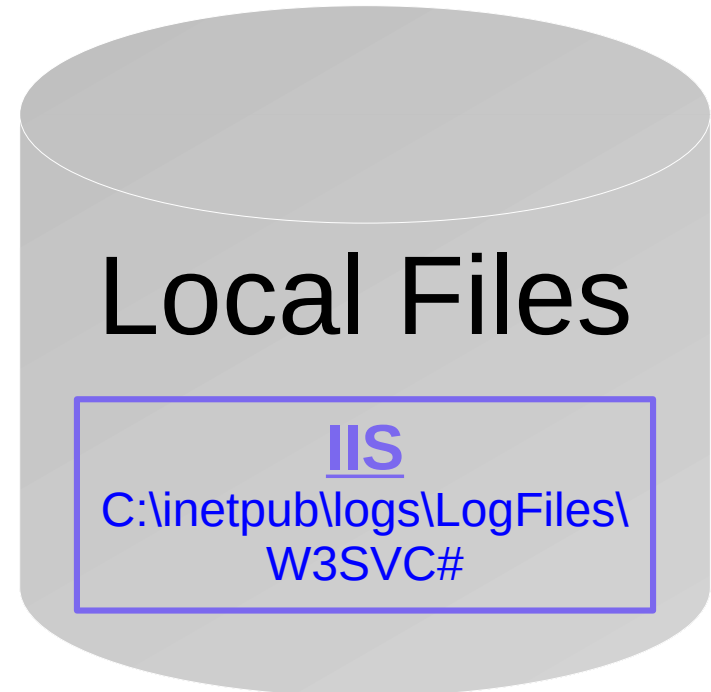
/var/log

Epoch timestamps

01-01-1970



Server Logs



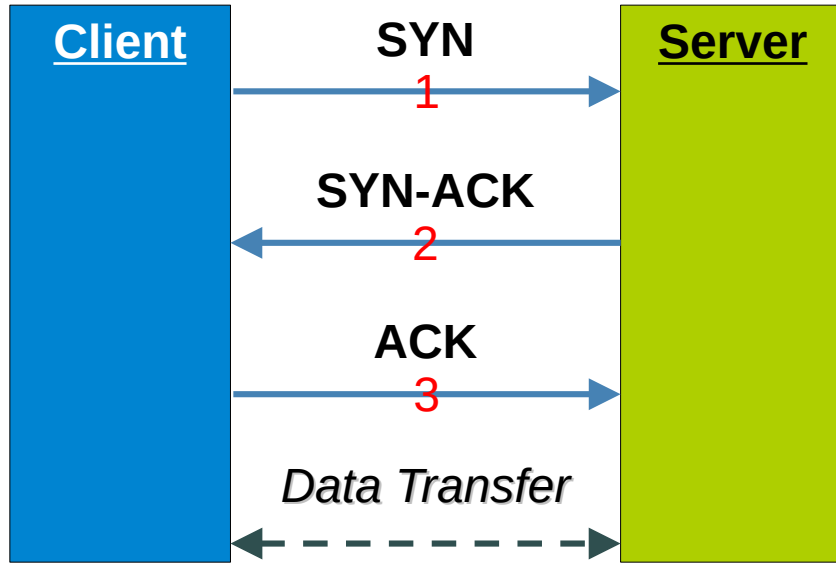
Application Logs



Centralized
Console

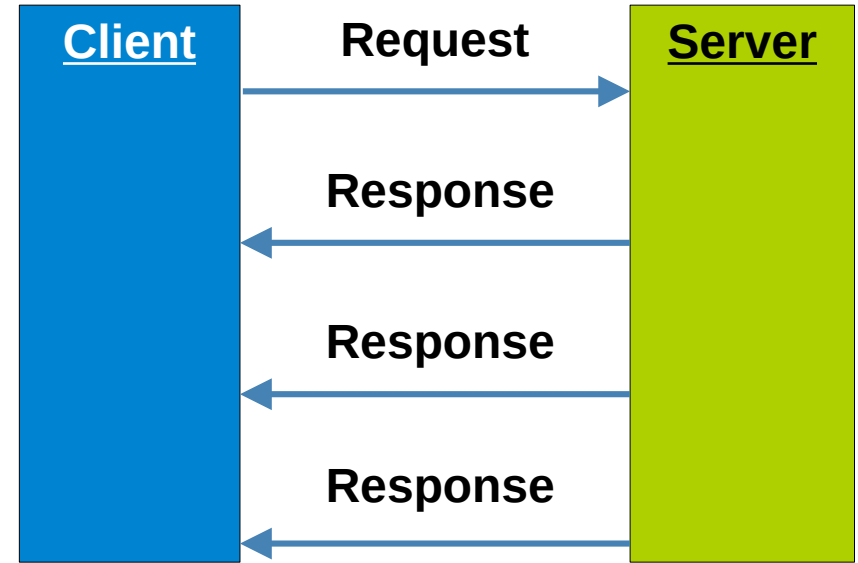
Network Transport Protocols

TCP



(3-way handshake)

UDP



(connectionless)

Computer Network Ports

TCP

22 (SSH)

80 (HTTP)

443 (HTTPS)

445 (SMB)

3389 (RDP)

UDP

53 (DNS)

67/68 (DHCP)

123 (NTP)

161 (SNMP)

Others



HTTP Request Methods

GET

HEAD

CONNECT

OPTIONS



POST

PUT

DELETE

TRACE

PATCH

HTTP Response Codes



200
series
(*"Ok" codes*)

300
series
(*redirects*)

400
series
(*client errors*)

500
series
(*server errors*)

OWASP Top 10



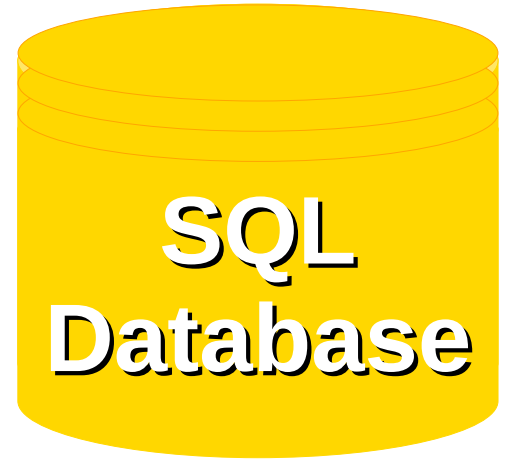
Open Web Application
Security Project, [Top 10](#)



Structured Query Language

Free online training

- <https://www.sqlcourse.com/beginner-course/>
- <https://www.sqlcourse.com/advanced-course/>



Data Encoding

String	Hello attendees!
Base64	SGVsbG8gYXR0ZW5kZWVzIQ==
ROT13	Uryyb nggrqrrf!
HEX (from ASCII)	48 65 6c 6c 6f 20 61 74 74 65 6e 64 65 65 73 21

NOTE:	All 3 encoding methods are commonplace
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IOCs & TTPs

Indicators of Compromise

- **Filenames & Paths**
- **Hashes**
- **IP addresses**
- **Domains & URLs**

File Execution?

Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

- **MITRE ATT&CK framework**
 - <https://attack.mitre.org>

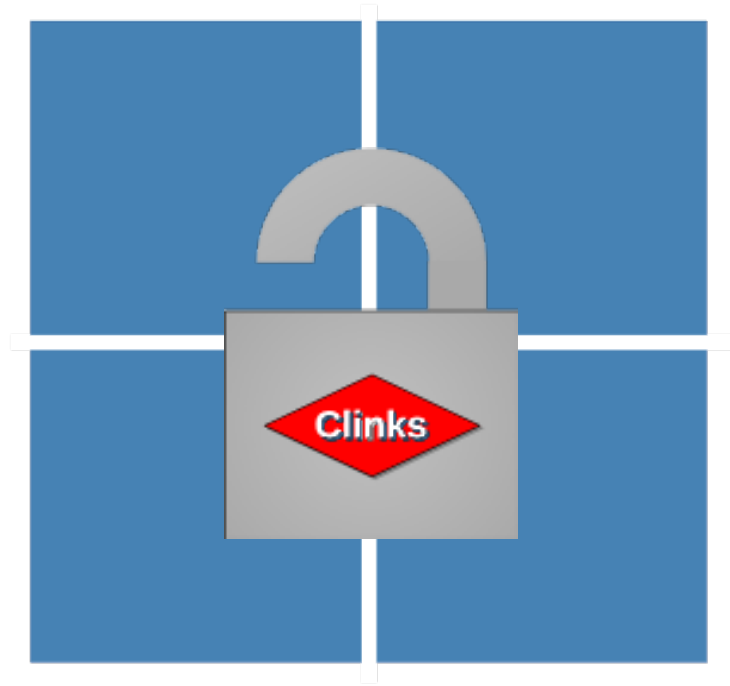
Persistence
TA0003

Windows Design & Security

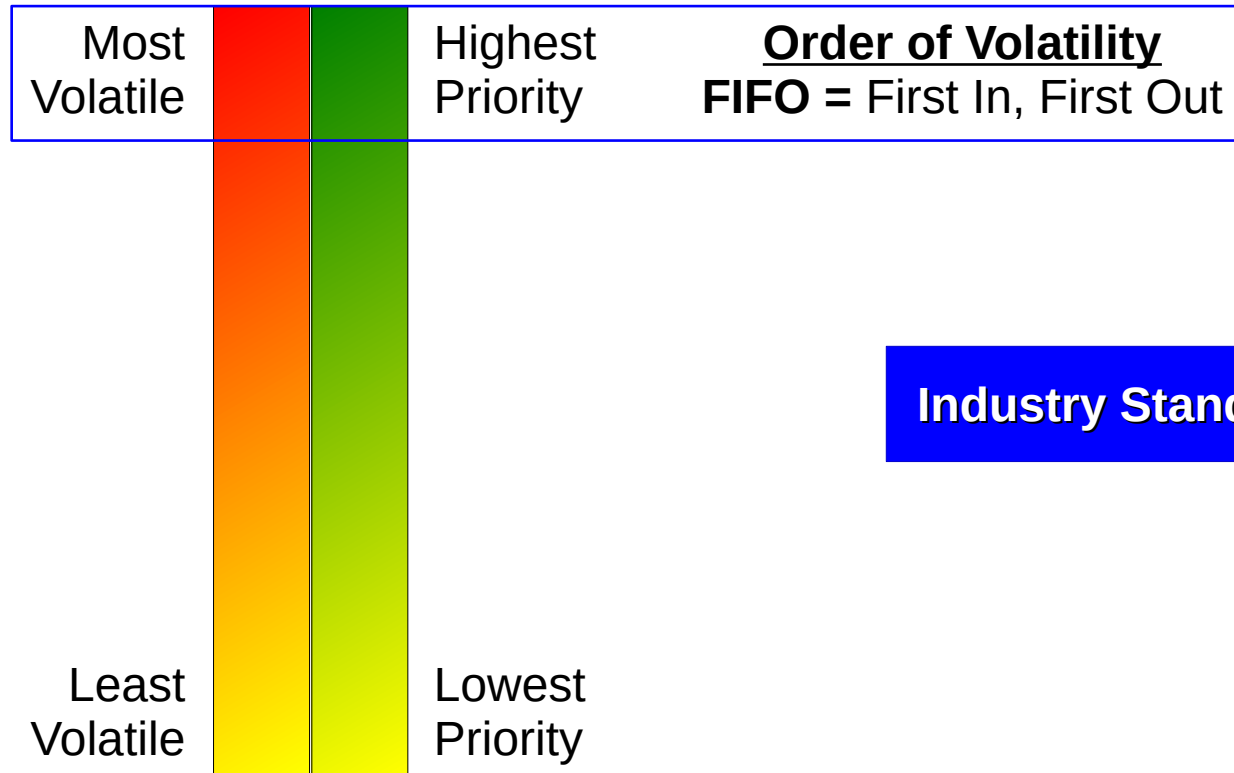
50+ auto-executable file extensions



Ready!
Fire!
Aim?
...Whoops!!!



Volatile Data Collection



Industry Standards

RFC 3227



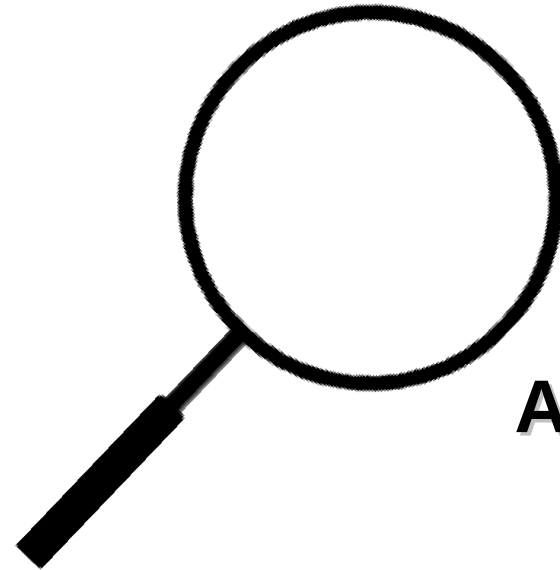
NIST SP 800-86



Digital Forensics



<https://youtu.be/t4Vy3irI0Tk>



**These
Artifacts
Aren't
Fiction**

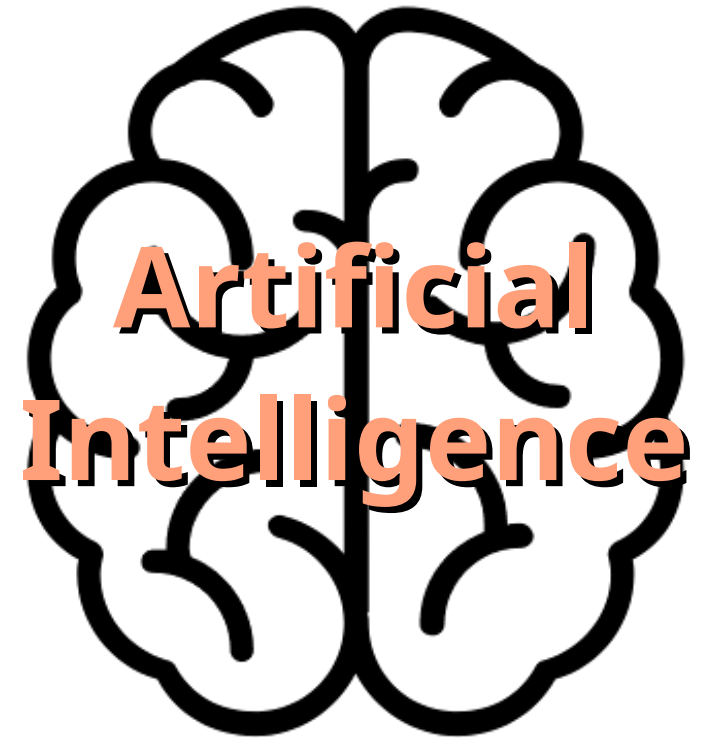
Cloud Security



<https://youtu.be/0vijJ7r-c8s>

Cloud Security
and Other Assorted
Cautionary Tales

“The New Hotness”



Ways (A)I Benefited

Daily Tasks

Communications

Note Taking

Summarizing

Research

Finding Things

IR Work

Code Analysis

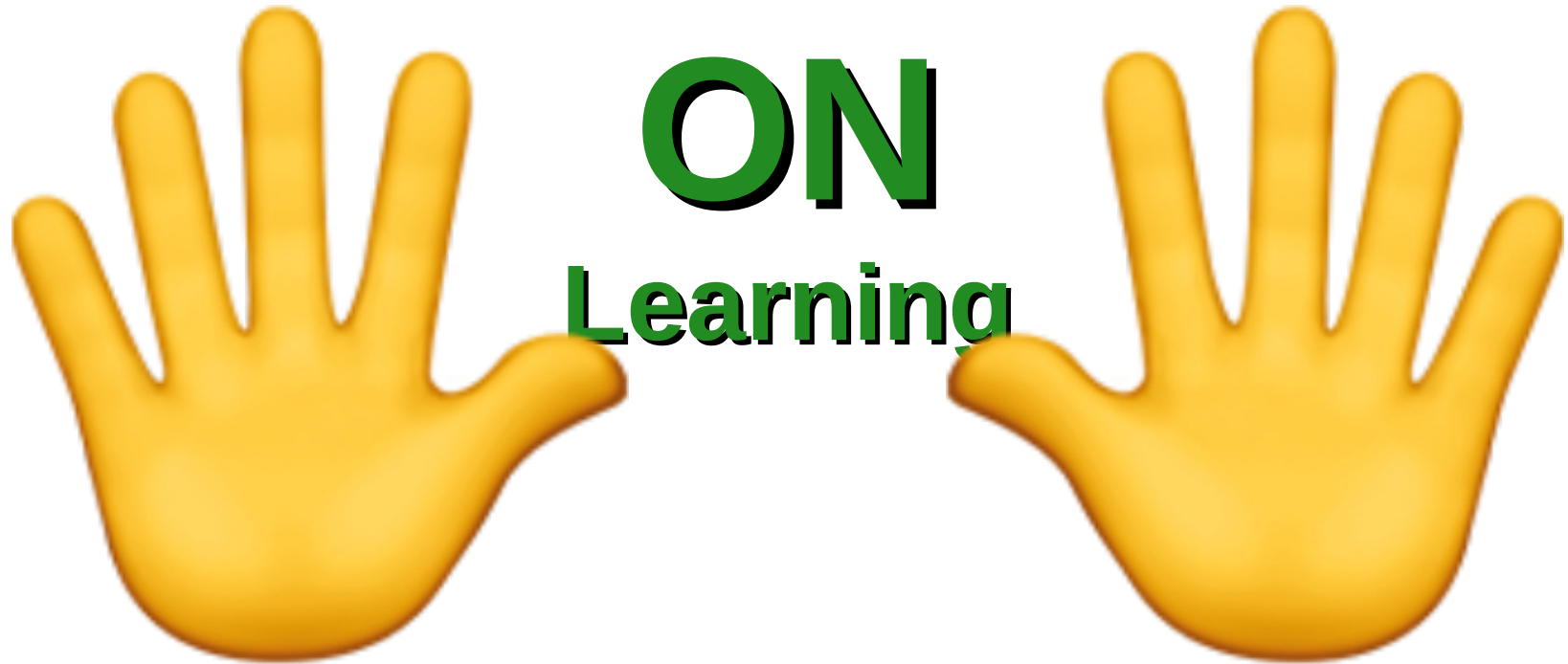
Code/Query Generation

Log Analysis

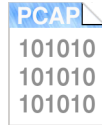
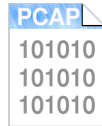
Triage Guidance

Event Correlation

The Best Way to Learn

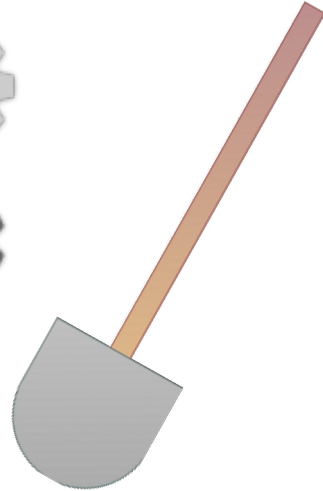
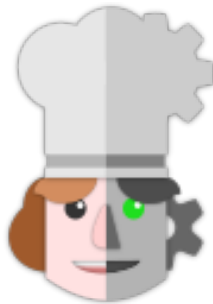
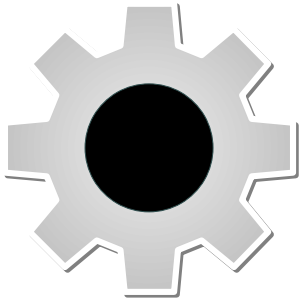


Network Packet Analysis



<https://workshops.dfir-matt.com>

CyberChef



<https://workshops.dfir-matt.com>

Kusto Query Language

KQL



<https://workshops.dfir.matt.com>

Tools to Learn

- Incident Response & Forensics tools in
 - **Kali Linux** (Yes, really!)
 - **REMnux** (Linux)
 - **SANS SIFT Workstation** (Linux)
 - **CSI Linux**
 - **FireEye's FLARE VM** (Windows)

IR Ride Along



<https://youtu.be/kjf-fBrSzVA>



Questions



Who?
What?
When?
Where?
Why?
How?



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